

EB1A & EB2-NIW Citation Strategy

Govt Citations • EDU Contributions • Major Significance • OCMS

Based on Strategic Research Methodology

How to Get .gov, .edu, and Journal Citations for Immigration Success

EB1A Prong 1: What USCIS Looks For

Original Contributions of Major Significance

Answer: USCIS requires evidence that your work has had major significance and sustained acclaim in your field. **Key evidence types:**

- Citations from .gov domains (federal agencies)
- Citations from .edu domains (universities)
- High-impact journal citations (Scopus, Web of Science)
- Evidence your work influenced policy, regulation, or practice
- Expert opinions confirming your contributions

Volume alone is not enough - quality and significance matter most.

EB2-NIW: What USCIS Requires

National Interest Waiver Criteria

Answer: EB2-NIW requires demonstrating three things:

- 1 Your proposed endeavor has substantial merit and national importance
- 2 You are well-positioned to advance the proposed endeavor
- 3 On balance, it would be beneficial to the U.S. to waive the job offer and labor certification

Government citations and policy influence directly prove "national importance" and "substantial merit."

Why .gov Citations Are So Powerful for Immigration

Government Domain Citations - Highest Credibility

Answer: .gov citations are considered high-value evidence because:

- Federal agencies do not cite irrelevant or low-quality work
- A .gov citation proves your work influenced U.S. government policy
- USCIS officers recognize .gov domains as authoritative sources
- Verifiable - the citation can be checked online instantly
- Demonstrates "national importance" for NIW cases
- Proves "major significance" for EB1A petitions

A single .gov citation can be worth dozens of regular journal citations.

Understanding Citations vs. Indexing vs. Commenting

Three Different Types of Evidence

Answer: Each type serves a different purpose: **Citations:** Your work directly referenced by another author; found in Google Scholar, Scopus; most valuable for EB1A. **Indexing:** Your work stored in a database (ERIC, PubMed, Science.gov); shows discoverability; good for NIW. **Commenting:** Submit feedback to Regulations.gov; creates official public record; excellent for policy influence.

How Many Citations Are Enough for EB1A?

Citation Targets - What Actually Works

Answer: No fixed number, but realistic targets: **Minimum (with strong other evidence):**

- 50-100 total citations
- At least 5-10 .gov or policy citations

Competitive (strong EB1A case):

- 200-500+ total citations
- Multiple .gov and .edu citations
- Peer review for prestigious journals

Quality matters more than quantity - one policy citation can be worth 50 journal citations.

Setting Realistic Citation Targets by Field

Field-Specific Expectations

Answer: Citation norms vary by discipline: **Social Sciences & Humanities:** 50-150 citations = strong; focus on .gov citations. **STEM Fields:** 200-500 citations = competitive; 500+ = extraordinary. **Computer Science & Engineering:** Conference papers cited less; GitHub stars matter too.

How to Get .gov Citations: The Complete Strategy

Six Proven Methods for Government Citations

Answer: Six reliable ways to get cited by government agencies:

- 1 **Regulations.gov Commenting:** Submit research-backed comments
- 2 **Federal Agency Reports:** Get cited in BLS, Fed, DOE reports
- 3 **CLEAR Database:** Create datasets for DOL's CLEAR system
- 4 **Government RFI Responses:** Respond to agency RFIs
- 5 **Federal Contract Work:** Work on government-funded research
- 6 **Collaboration with Federal Researchers:** Co-author with government scientists

Regulations.gov commenting is the most accessible method.

Step-by-Step Commenting Strategy

Step 1 - Find Relevant RFIs:

- Visit Regulations.gov and search your topic
- Look for "Request for Information" (RFI) or "Notice of Proposed Rulemaking" (NPRM)

Step 2 - Write Research-Backed Comments:

- Cite your own published research
- Reference peer-reviewed literature
- Provide data-driven recommendations
- Keep professional tone (500-2000 words)

How to Format Your Comments

Required elements:

- Docket number (e.g., "Docket No. EPA-HQ-OAR-2022-1234")
- Your name and affiliation
- Clear subject line
- Executive summary (1-2 paragraphs)
- Detailed analysis with citations
- Specific recommendations

Pro tip: Use LaTeX to format professionally before uploading as PDF. [Comments become official public record and can be cited by others.](#)

How to Track When Your Comment Gets Cited

Monitoring Your Policy Impact

What to watch for:

- Agency final rules may reference comments received
- Federal agency reports may cite your research
- Other commenters may reference your submission
- Google Scholar may index the final rule (with your citation!)

Documentation strategy:

- Save docket number and confirmation email
- Screenshot your comment on the public portal
- Download PDFs for your portfolio

CLEAR DOL: Creating Datasets for Department of Labor

CLEAR Database - What It Is

Answer: CLEAR (Clearinghouse for Labor Evaluation and Research) is DOL's evidence database. **How to get indexed:**

- Publish rigorous research on labor topics (workforce, jobs, training)
- Ensure strong methodology (RCT, quasi-experimental)
- Submit through CLEAR online portal
- DOL reviews and indexes quality studies

CLEAR indexing proves: Research meets federal quality standards and influences labor policy.

Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) Citations

How to Get Cited by BLS

Methods:

- Publish on labor economics, workforce trends, employment statistics
- Submit comments to BLS RFIs
- Collaborate with BLS researchers
- Get referenced in BLS Monthly Labor Review

How to check if BLS cited you:

- Search BLS publications for your name
- Use Google Scholar with "site:bls.gov" + your name
- Check Crossref XML for DOI resolution

BLS citations prove your work influences national workforce policy.

Federal Reserve Citations: Getting Cited by the Fed

How to Get Cited by Federal Reserve

Strategies:

- Publish on monetary policy, banking, financial stability
- Submit comments to Fed RFIs (payment systems, crypto regulation)
- Collaborate with Fed economists
- Get cited in FEDS Working Papers

Key Fed publications to target:

- FEDS Working Papers
- FedNotes
- Beige Books
- Consumer Compliance Outlook

Science.gov Indexing: Federal Repositories

Science.gov - Gateway to Federal Science

How to get indexed:

- Publish in journals indexed by PubMed, ERIC, or DOAJ
- Submit to federal agency repositories (NASA ADS, DOE OSTI)
- Ensure your work has a DOI
- Use clear, searchable titles and abstracts

Pathways to Science.gov:

- NASA ADS → Science.gov
- Harvard ADS → Science.gov
- ERIC → Science.gov
- PubMed → Science.gov

Indexing proves federal recognition of your research.

Education Resources Information Center (ERIC)

Answer: ERIC is the U.S. Department of Education's digital library. **Why ERIC indexing is valuable:**

- .gov domain authority
- Work becomes searchable by educators and policymakers
- Demonstrates educational impact for NIW
- Can be cited by .edu domains
- Free access increases citation potential

How to Get Your Work Indexed in ERIC

ERIC Indexing Requirements

Pathways to ERIC indexing:

- 1 Publish in ERIC-approved journals (many education journals)
- 2 Submit directly to ERIC (unpublished research, reports, dissertations)
- 3 Conference proceedings (some education conferences)
- 4 Open peer review journals (if ERIC-approved)

Journal characteristics: Peer-reviewed, English, education focus, has ISSN.

Best Journals for ERIC Indexing

Mid-tier (easier acceptance):

- Journal of Education and Learning (EduLearn)
- International Journal of Instruction
- Journal of Technology and Science Education

Higher-tier (more citations):

- Computers & Education (Elsevier) - Scopus Q1
- Educational Technology Research and Development (Springer)
- British Journal of Educational Technology (Wiley)

Aim for mid-tier first, then higher-tier after establishing record.

How ERIC Citations Help Your Immigration Case

Demonstrating Educational Impact

Evidence for EB1A/EB2-NIW:

- ERIC is a .gov domain - automatic credibility
- Proves research reaches educators nationwide
- Demonstrates "substantial merit" for NIW
- Counts as "professional recognition"

How to document:

- Save ERIC abstract page with .gov URL
- Track citations to your ERIC-indexed work
- Monitor download statistics

Journal Selection Checklist for Maximum Citations

How to Identify High-Citation-Potential Journals

Checklist:

- ✓ Indexed in Scopus, Web of Science, or DOAJ
- ✓ Has Journal Impact Factor
- ✓ Published by recognized publisher (Elsevier, Springer, Wiley, Taylor & Francis)
- ✓ No predatory red flags
- ✓ Quick publication (2-6 months)
- ✓ Open access option available
- ✓ Has DOIs for all articles
- ✓ Indexed in Google Scholar

Avoid predatory journals - they cause RFEs.

Research Topics with High Citation Velocity

Topics Getting Cited Rapidly (2024-2026)

Artificial Intelligence:

- LLMs in various applications
- AI ethics, governance, regulation
- Generative AI in education and workforce

Cybersecurity:

- Zero-trust architecture
- AI security and adversarial ML
- Critical infrastructure protection

FinTech & Financial Regulation:

- Cryptocurrency regulation
- Digital assets and stablecoins
- AI in banking compliance

Cross-Disciplinary Research for Broader Impact

How to Increase Citations Through Interdisciplinary Work

High-impact combinations:

- AI + Education (AI literacy, personalized learning)
- AI + Finance (algorithmic trading risk, fraud detection)
- AI + Cybersecurity (adversarial ML, threat detection)
- FinTech + Regulation (compliance automation)

Why it works: Reaches multiple communities, cited across fields, attractive to RFI.

Using LaTeX for Academic Publishing

Why use LaTeX:

- Preferred by most STEM journals
- Automatic formatting to journal specs
- Handles references automatically (BibTeX)
- Free (Overleaf, TeX Live)

Where to get templates:

- Overleaf (overleaf.com/latex/templates)
- Journal websites (download .cls files)
- GitHub

Learn basic LaTeX - worth the investment.

Zotero: Citation Management for Immigration Evidence

Using Zotero to Track Your Citations

Why Zotero for immigration:

- Automatically pulls citation data from Google Scholar
- Creates formatted bibliographies
- Generates citation reports
- Stores PDFs
- Free and open source

How to use:

- Create "My Publications" collection
- Add all papers, preprints, comments
- Use "Create Citation Report" to show times cited
- Track who cites you (.gov, .edu, journals)

Using AI (DeepSeek, ChatGPT) for Research Writing

AI Tools to Accelerate Publication

How to use AI responsibly:

- Generate literature review summaries
- Edit and polish existing writing
- Create LaTeX code for tables/figures
- Brainstorm research questions

Be careful:

- Always verify AI-generated information
- Do not submit AI text without editing
- Many journals prohibit AI as co-author
- **Do not use for peer review** - violates policies

How to Get Peer Review Opportunities

Building Your Peer Review Portfolio

Strategies:

- ① Start small: Review for new or lower-tier journals
- ② Contact journal editors: Send CV and expertise
- ③ Complete reviewer profiles: Register on ScholarOne, Editorial Manager
- ④ Publish first: Editors invite established authors
- ⑤ Ask mentors: Senior colleagues can recommend you

Evidence to keep: Invitation emails, review confirmations, certificates, editor thank-you letters.

Peer Review Certifications from Publishers

Which Publishers Provide Reviewer Certificates

Publishers with certification programs:

- **Elsevier:** Web of Science Reviewer Recognition
- **Wiley:** Reviewer Certificates available
- **Springer:** Publons integration
- **Taylor & Francis:** Reviewer recognition
- **MDPI:** Immediate certificate download
- **Frontiers:** Certificates with feedback

How to collect: Create Publons profile, connect ORCID, upload confirmations, download certificates.

How to Document Peer Review for USCIS

Evidence Package for "Judging the Work of Others"

Required evidence:

- 1 Invitation to review (journal email)
- 2 Confirmation of completed review
- 3 Reviewer certificate (if available)
- 4 Screenshot of acknowledgment page
- 5 Editor's thank-you letter

What USCIS looks for:

- Prestigious journals (impact factor)
- Multiple reviews (5+ minimum)
- Span of time (1-3 years)
- Invitations based on expertise

Mixture of Experts: Non-Peer-Reviewed Long Papers

Using Long-Form Articles to Build Authority

What "Mixture of Experts" means:

- Invited book chapters
- Encyclopedia entries
- Professional magazine articles (IEEE Spectrum)
- Industry white papers
- Policy briefs
- Technical reports

How to use: Showcase breadth, reach different audiences, generate organic citations.

How to Get Cited by US Universities (.edu Domains)

Five Methods for .edu Citations

- ① Collaborate with university researchers - co-author papers
- ② Get cited in course materials - reach out to professors
- ③ University press publications - submit to university journals
- ④ Institutional repositories - deposit in Harvard DASH, MIT DSpace
- ⑤ Present at university seminars - get referenced in proceedings

Most accessible: Identify professors, send publications, offer materials, ask to be considered for course readings.

Tracking .edu Citations Using Google Scholar

How to Find University Citations

Step-by-step:

- 1 Go to Google Scholar My Profile
- 2 Click "Cited by" number for your work
- 3 Look at URLs of citing works
- 4 Filter for URLs containing ".edu"
- 5 Save these citations to your portfolio

Advanced search: "your name" site:.edu Citations from Harvard, MIT, Stanford are especially valuable.

PubMed Indexing and Citation Strategy

How to get PubMed citations:

- Publish in PubMed-indexed journals
- Focus on NIH mission topics (public health, medicine, health policy)
- Collaborate with NIH-funded researchers
- Submit to medRxiv preprint server

Why PubMed matters:

- .gov domain authority
- Accessible to U.S. health policymakers
- Demonstrates health-related national importance

Upload Your Paper Everywhere: Multi-Platform Strategy

Maximum Visibility Through Multiple Platforms

Where to upload:

- **Preprint servers:** arXiv, SSRN, medRxiv, bioRxiv
- **Institutional repositories:** University digital archive
- **ResearchGate, Academia.edu**
- **HAL:** French open archive
- **MPRA, EconPapers** (economics)
- **EBSCO:** Commercial database

Each platform increases discoverability and citation potential.

EBSCO, ProQuest, and HAL: Getting Indexed

Commercial and International Indexing

EBSCOhost: Used by 1000s of university libraries; publish in EBSCO-indexed journals. **ProQuest:** Dissertations, theses, conference proceedings; submit through university library. **HAL:** French government-supported; indexed by Google Scholar; accepts English submissions.

US Commerce Library Indexing Through EBSCO

Getting Your Work in the U.S. Commerce Research Library

How to get indexed:

- Publish in EBSCO's Business Source Complete journals
- Focus on trade, economics, business, technology
- Ensure journal is in Commerce Library holdings

Why this matters:

- Direct .gov indexing
- Accessible to U.S. Department of Commerce policymakers
- Verifiable by USCIS through .gov website

Cybersecurity as the Second Most Important Topic

Why Cybersecurity Is Highly Valued

Why cybersecurity citations are powerful:

- Direct national importance for NIW
- Federal agencies cite security research (NIST, CISA, NSA)
- Executive Orders prioritize cybersecurity
- Shortage of U.S. cybersecurity experts

Key government resources:

- NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF)
- CISA Alerts
- Executive Order 14028

AI as the Most Important Topic for Government Citations

Why AI Research Gets the Most .gov Citations

Why AI is valuable:

- Executive Order 14110 (Safe, Secure, Trustworthy AI)
- NIST AI Risk Management Framework
- Federal AI research funding (NSF, DOE, DARPA)
- AI regulation through FTC, FCC, SEC, CFPB

AI topics that get government attention:

- AI safety and alignment
- Algorithmic bias and fairness
- Generative AI regulation (LLMs, deepfakes)

OSF: Open Science Framework - Why It Matters for EB1A/EB2-NIW

What is OSF?

Answer: OSF (osf.io) is a free, open-source research management platform maintained by the Center for Open Science (COS), which receives funding from federal agencies including the National Institutes of Health (NIH) and the National Science Foundation (NSF). OSF allows researchers to upload preprints, preprints, datasets, registered research protocols, and entire research workflows.

Why OSF is strategically important for immigration evidence:

- **OSF Preprints receive permanent DOIs** - your work becomes citable immediately, before journal peer review. Citations start accruing the day you upload.
- **OSF Preprints are harvested by SHARE** - a project of the U.S. Department of Education. Your work automatically becomes discoverable through .gov portals.
- **Federal agencies (NIH, NSF, DOE) mandate OSF for open data compliance** - using OSF demonstrates that your research meets federal

OSF Preprints: The Connection to Government Recognition

How OSF Preprints Lead to .gov and .edu Citations

Answer: When you upload a preprint to OSF, it is assigned a DOI (Digital Object Identifier) and becomes part of the global scholarly record. Unlike a personal blog or institutional repository, OSF Preprints are actively harvested by U.S. government systems. **The government citation pathway:**

- **SHARE (share.osf.io)** is a joint project of the U.S. Department of Education and the Center for Open Science. SHARE crawls OSF Preprints and makes them searchable through .gov portals. Your preprint becomes part of the official U.S. government research database.
- **CHORUS (chorusaccess.org)** connects OSF Preprints to federal agency reports. When a federal agency publishes a report citing research, OSF preprints are included in the citation tracking.
- **PubMed Central (PMC)** accepts preprints that are later published as peer-reviewed articles. OSF preprints with DOIs can be referenced in NIH grant reports.

OSF Preprint Communities: Aligning with Federal Priorities

OSF Preprint Communities That Maximize Government Visibility

Answer: OSF organizes preprints into communities. Choosing the right community determines which federal agencies are most likely to discover and cite your work. **High-impact communities for EB1A/EB2-NIW:**

- **CSRC Preprints** - the Computer Security Research Center community, aligned with NIST (National Institute of Standards and Technology). Research posted here is directly visible to NIST cybersecurity researchers who produce federal guidelines like the NIST Cybersecurity Framework. Citations from NIST reports become .gov citations.
- **EdArXiv** - the education preprint community, partnered with the U.S. Department of Education. Preprints posted here are automatically harvested by ERIC (.gov) and SHARE. This is the fastest pathway to .gov indexing for education and workforce development research.
- **SocArXiv** - social sciences preprints, harvested by SHARE and indexed in U.S. government social science databases. Relevant for policy research,

OSF Preprint DOIs: Why They Matter for Immigration

DOIs (Digital Object Identifiers) and Government Recognition

Answer: Every OSF preprint receives a permanent DOI - a unique alphanumeric string that permanently identifies your work. DOIs are the standard for academic citation and are recognized by all major databases including Google Scholar, Crossref, Scopus, and Web of Science. **Why OSF DOIs are valuable for**

EB1A/EB2-NIW:

- **DOIs create a permanent, verifiable record of your contribution.** USCIS officers can click the DOI link and immediately see your preprint, its download counts, and its citation history. Unlike a personal website or blog, a DOI-backed preprint cannot be altered or disputed.
- **DOIs enable citation tracking across .gov domains.** When a federal agency report cites your OSF preprint, the citation includes the DOI. USCIS can verify that citation by resolving the DOI to your work. This creates a direct, unbroken chain of evidence from your research to government recognition.
- **DOIs are indexed by Google Scholar within 2-4 weeks.** Your OSF preprint will appear in Google Scholar search results alongside peer-reviewed

OSF Registrations: Timestamped Evidence of Original Contributions

What OSF Registrations Are and Why They Matter

Answer: An OSF Registration is a timestamped, immutable snapshot of your research plan, methodology, or findings at a specific point in time. Unlike a preprint (which can be updated), a registration is frozen and cannot be altered after creation. **Why registrations are powerful evidence for EB1A:**

- **Registrations prove you were the originator of specific research ideas.** The timestamp on a registration serves as legal evidence of priority. If you register a research protocol on OSF and later publish the results, the registration proves when you first conceived the study.
- **Federal agencies require pre-registration for funded research.** NIH and NSF both require or strongly encourage pre-registration of clinical trials and certain types of research. Complying with federal standards demonstrates that your research meets U.S. government quality expectations.
- **The Preregistration Challenge on OSF was funded by NSF.** The Center for Open Science received NSF funding to promote pre-registration.

OSF and Federal Data Management Plans (DMPs)

Meeting Federal Data Management Requirements Through OSF

Answer: Most U.S. federal research agencies now require Data Management Plans (DMPs) for grant applications. OSF integrates directly with DMPTool, the federally approved DMP creation platform. **Which agencies require DMPs that OSF supports:**

- **National Science Foundation (NSF)** - requires a two-page DMP for all grant proposals. DMPTool is the NSF-recommended platform. OSF projects can be linked to DMPs created in DMPTool.
- **National Institutes of Health (NIH)** - requires DMPs for all grant proposals requesting \$500,000 or more in direct costs. OSF meets NIH data sharing requirements.
- **Department of Energy (DOE)** - requires DMPs for all research funded by DOE. OSF is approved for DOE data management.
- **Department of Defense (DoD)** - requires DMPs for basic research funding. OSF meets DoD requirements for unclassified research.

Why DMP compliance matters for immigration:

OSF Metrics: Quantifying Your Research Impact

What Metrics OSF Provides and How to Use Them

Answer: OSF automatically tracks and displays several metrics for every preprint and project. These metrics provide quantifiable evidence of your research impact.

Metrics OSF tracks:

- **Downloads** - the number of times your preprint has been downloaded. High download counts indicate that other researchers and practitioners find your work valuable. International downloads demonstrate global reach.
- **Views** - the number of times your OSF project page has been viewed. This includes visits from .edu and .gov domains (which you can document).
- **Citations** - OSF integrates with Google Scholar to display citation counts directly on your preprint page. USCIS officers can see at a glance how many times your work has been cited.
- **Fork count** - how many other researchers have created copies (forks) of your OSF project to reuse your methodology. Forks prove that other researchers are building directly on your work.
- **Storage usage** - less relevant, but shows the scale and complexity of your

OSF + Regulations.gov: The Complete Policy Influence Pathway

How OSF Preprints Strengthen Policy Comments

Answer: The most powerful combination for EB1A "major significance" evidence is an OSF preprint that you then cite in a Regulations.gov policy comment. **The complete pathway:**

- 1 You publish a research preprint on OSF, receiving a permanent DOI.
- 2 Your OSF preprint is indexed by Google Scholar, SHARE, and other government systems.
- 3 You submit a comment to a federal agency's Request for Information (RFI) or Notice of Proposed Rulemaking (NPRM) on Regulations.gov.
- 4 In your comment, you cite your own OSF preprint DOI as evidence supporting your recommendations.
- 5 The agency considers your comment as part of the official record. If the agency cites your comment or your preprint in the final rule, you receive a .gov citation.

OSF: Summary of Immigration Benefits

Why Every EB1A/EB2-NIW Applicant Should Use OSF

Answer: OSF provides unique advantages that cannot be obtained through traditional journal publication alone. **Eight reasons OSF strengthens your immigration case:**

- 1 **Permanent DOIs** - your work becomes citable immediately, not after months of peer review.
- 2 **.gov harvesting** - SHARE (Department of Education) automatically indexes your work.
- 3 **Federal compliance** - OSF meets NIH, NSF, and DOE data management requirements.
- 4 **Timestamped registrations** - proves you originated specific research ideas.
- 5 **Download metrics** - quantifiable evidence of impact and sustained acclaim.
- 6 **Integration with Regulations.gov** - cite your own preprints in policy comments.
- 7 **Google Scholar indexing** - your OSF preprints appear alongside journal

How to Get a Congressman or Senator Support Letter

Step-by-Step Strategy

Step 1 - Identify the right office:

- Your local Representative
- Senators from your state
- Members with expertise in your field

Step 2 - Prepare request packet:

- Cover letter explaining national importance
- 2-3 page research summary
- Citation report (.gov, .edu, journal)
- Draft letter of support

Step 3 - Submit: Website contact form or mail to district office.

What to Include in a Congressional Support Letter Request

Components of a Successful Request

Draft letter should include:

- Statement of your expertise
- Description of research and applications
- How your work serves U.S. national interests
- Evidence of recognition (.gov citations, peer review)
- Specific USCIS wording ("extraordinary ability," "national importance")

What NOT to ask: Do not ask them to endorse immigration decisions or contact USCIS directly.

Complete EB1A/EB2-NIW Citation Evidence Checklist

Before Submitting Your Petition

Domain 1: Government Citations (.gov)

- ☐ Regulations.gov comments (with docket numbers)
- ☐ Federal agency citations (BLS, Fed, DOE, DOL)
- ☐ CLEAR DOL dataset indexing
- ☐ Science.gov indexing confirmation

Domain 2: Educational Impact (.edu)

- ☐ ERIC-indexed publications
- ☐ University citations (Google Scholar .edu)
- ☐ Course material inclusions

Complete EB1A/EB2-NIW Checklist (continued)

Before Submitting Your Petition

Domain 3: Peer Review & Expert Recognition

- ☐ 5+ peer review certificates (minimum)
- ☐ Editorial board memberships
- ☐ Invitation emails from journals

Domain 4: Publication & Citation Metrics

- ☐ Google Scholar profile with citations
- ☐ Scopus/Web of Science citation report
- ☐ Total citations (aim for 50+)

Domain 5: Supporting Evidence

- ☐ Congressional or Senator support letter
- ☐ Expert opinion letters

How to Present Your Evidence to USCIS

Documentation Strategy for Maximum Impact

Structure your exhibit tabs:

- 1 **Tab A:** .gov Citations
- 2 **Tab B:** .edu Citations
- 3 **Tab C:** Journal Citations
- 4 **Tab D:** Peer Review Evidence
- 5 **Tab E:** Support Letters
- 6 **Tab F:** Portfolio of Publications

For each citation: Screenshot, highlight your name, include URL, save as PDF.

Timeline for Building Your Citation Portfolio

Realistic Timeline from Zero to EB1A-Ready (12-24 months)

Months 1-3: Set up Zotero, Google Scholar; identify journals; draft first paper.

Months 4-8: Submit to journal; begin Regulations.gov commenting; apply for peer review. **Months 9-12:** Track citations; submit second paper; request

congressional letter. **Months 13-18:** Upload to multiple platforms; seek .edu and government citations. **Months 19-24:** Organize exhibits; draft petition; consult attorney.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

What Can Hurt Your Immigration Case

Evidence mistakes:

- Submitting predatory journal publications
- Claiming unverifiable citations
- Missing .gov or .edu evidence

Strategy mistakes:

- Focusing only on volume (quality matters more)
- Ignoring policy and government engagement
- Neglecting documentation

Petition mistakes:

- Poorly organized exhibits
- Missing URLs for online evidence

An RFE is common - prepare by keeping all documentation.

Final Success Checklist

Before You Submit Your Immigration Petition

- ☐ All .gov citations have working URLs
- ☐ .edu citations from accredited U.S. universities
- ☐ Peer review certificates signed and dated
- ☐ Google Scholar profile public and updated
- ☐ Publication PDFs clean and readable
- ☐ Exhibits organized and numbered
- ☐ Consulted with qualified immigration attorney
- ☐ Prepared for potential RFE with backup evidence

USCIS approves thousands of EB1A and EB2-NIW cases each year.

Resources and Next Steps

Where to Go From Here

Immediate actions (next 7 days):

- 1 Set up Google Scholar profile (free)
- 2 Install Zotero (free)
- 3 Identify 2-3 Regulations.gov RFIs
- 4 Create list of 5 target journals

Key websites to bookmark:

- [regulations.gov](https://www.regulations.gov)
- [science.gov](https://www.science.gov)
- eric.ed.gov
- clear.dol.gov
- pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov

Disclaimer and Legal Advice

Important Notice

Disclaimer: This provides educational guidance only and does not constitute legal advice. Immigration laws change regularly. **Recommendation:**

- Always consult a qualified immigration attorney
- Each case is unique
- USCIS officers have discretion
- This teaches strategies, not guarantees

Use this course to prepare evidence, then work with an attorney.

Your Path to EB1A/EB2-NIW Success Starts Here

- Implement strategies consistently
- Track your progress monthly
- Document everything systematically
- Build relationships with experts
- Stay persistent - impact takes time

The best time to start was yesterday. The second best time is now.
Good luck on your immigration journey!